Romantic Era & Early 20th-Century Music
Exam Review

Music 101 · Intro to Music

NAME _____ DATE _____ SCORE / 36

Read each direction before you start. Write clearly in pen or pencil.

Short answer

4 pts each

Answer in two to four complete sentences.

1 How does Erlking portray its characters and the galloping horse?

2 How is the idée fixe presented in movement V of the Symphonie fantastique?

3 How did Brahms's Requiem text differ from the traditional one?

4 Why is Scott Joplin called the "King of Ragtime," and how did he achieve financial security?

5 How could rags be performed before recordings were widespread?

6 Why was a conductor needed in the Romantic era, and what instruments were added to the orchestra?

7 How did the Industrial Revolution influence Romantic music?

8 What role did the piano play in 19th-century life?

9 How were 19th-century Masses, Requiems, and oratorios characterized?

Answer key

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KEY POINTS

1. One singer portrays four characters: narrator, father, son, and the Erlking. Repeated piano triplets depict the galloping horse.

2. It is distorted and grotesque, played on a shrill clarinet.

3. Brahms used German Bible texts instead of the Latin liturgy.

4. He is known by that title as the leading ragtime composer. He achieved financial security by insisting on receiving royalties rather than a flat payment.

5. They could be performed mechanically by player pianos.

6. The larger Romantic orchestra created the need for a conductor. New instruments were the piccolo, English horn, tuba, and contrabassoon.

7. It brought technical improvements to instruments that influenced the sound of Romantic music.

8. It was central to home life; families gathered around the piano to make and hear music.

9. They were large-scale genres with enormous choral and orchestral resources, typically performed as concert works rather than in church.

Print this page separately so the key isn't handed out with the quiz.